



WEEK SIX · MODULE ONE

The Network and The Market

Where the roles are, how this world hires, and how you build access from nothing

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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HOW TO STUDY THIS MODULE

A word before you begin, and it is the most honest sentence in this programme. Maison Amarine does not place you, does not introduce you, and does not promise you a role.

What this week gives you is the map and the method, which is a great deal more useful than a list of names you did not earn, and which nobody would answer anyway.

Your deliverable is your own market entry plan. By Sunday you will know exactly what you are doing on Monday.

CHAPTER I

How this market actually works

And why the job boards are the last place to look

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand the structure of a market that is mostly invisible.

Stop applying, and start being introduced.

I.I · The structure

The private service market has a shape that almost nobody explains to newcomers, and misunderstanding it is why capable people spend a year applying to advertisements and receiving nothing at all.

Layer	What it is, and how a role is filled there
The advertised market	What you can see. Agency listings, a handful of job boards, the occasional direct posting. Real, and it is the smallest layer, and it is the most competitive because everyone can see it.
The agency market	Filled from a list that already exists. The agency does not begin looking when the family calls: it opens a folder of people it already knows. Being in the folder, before the role exists, is the entire game.
The referral market	A principal asks another principal. An estate manager asks a former colleague. A butler recommends a friend. This is where a great many of the best roles go, and none of them are ever seen by anyone outside a very small circle.
The invisible market	A role that is created because a specific person became available. It is not filled. It is written around someone. It is the most senior tier and it will apply to you in about eight years.

THE SENTENCE THAT REFRAMES THE WEEK

In this market, you are not looking for a job. You are making sure that when your name is said in a room you are not in, the right thing is said about you.

Everything in this module is a method for making that happen deliberately rather than by luck.

1.2 · Why the advertised market treats you badly

An agency listing at this level receives an enormous number of applications, and the great majority are from people with no relevant experience who have read the salary. Your carefully written letter arrives in that pile. This is not unfair. It is simply arithmetic, and no amount of care in the letter changes the arithmetic.

The same letter, sent by an agency consultant to a family with the sentence "I know her, she is good", is not in a pile at all. Same person. Same letter. Entirely different market. That sentence is what you spend this week learning how to earn.

CHAPTER II

The map

Where the roles physically are, and when

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Know the geography of the market and its seasons.

Choose a market deliberately rather than by accident of birth.

2.1 · The centres

Market	What you need to know
London	The deepest private household market in Europe, and the most professional agency infrastructure. Formal, reference-driven, and slow to trust an outsider. Roles range from a live-out head butler or house manager in a townhouse at around sixty-five to ninety thousand pounds, upwards.
Monaco and the Riviera	Concentrated, seasonal, extremely relationship-driven. Many roles are never advertised anywhere at all. French and English are effectively mandatory, Italian and Russian are advantages. Villa and estate roles in Antibes and Saint-Tropez run through the summer and are frequently packaged with housing.
Switzerland	Discreet, stable, well paid, and closed. Geneva, Zurich, Gstaad, Verbier. Chalet and guest-relations roles in season are a legitimate way in and they climb quickly.
The United States	The largest market by volume. New York, Palm Beach, the Hamptons, Los Angeles, Aspen, and increasingly the tech families in California. An estate manager in New York is commonly around two hundred thousand dollars, and multi-residence estate management with a large team can reach three hundred and fifty thousand as a package. Visa status is the whole question, and you must answer it honestly before you spend a year on it.
The Gulf	Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Riyadh, Doha. Tax free, frequently live-in, often royal or quasi-royal households. Salaries are commonly stated on request, and the packages can be very large. VVIP experience is usually required, so this is rarely a first rung, and the cultural expectations must be studied seriously and not assumed.

Market**What you need to know**

Yachts and aviation Its own market, with its own rules, its own certifications, and its own season. A genuinely excellent way in for someone with no household experience, it travels, and it is physically demanding in a way that people underestimate.

2.2 · The seasons

This market breathes, and knowing when it inhales is worth more than any single piece of advice in this module.

Period**What is happening**

January and February	Hiring for the year. Families reorganise after the holidays. Agencies are busy and receptive. This is the single best moment to make yourself known.
March to May	Recruitment for the summer season. Villas, chalets closing, yachts crewing up. If you want a summer role, you are already late in May.
June to August	The market is running, not hiring. Nobody is reading letters. Use it to build, to learn, and to work a season.
September and October	The second window. Post-summer reorganisation, and the winter season is being staffed. Nearly as good as January.
November and December	Quiet, and the exception is short-term holiday cover, which is a small and genuinely useful door.

CHAPTER III

The ladder

And the rung you can actually reach

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Place yourself honestly on the ladder.

Understand what each rung pays, and what it leads to.

3.1 • The honest conversation

These roles form a ladder, not a menu. The single most common error made by ambitious, capable people entering this profession is to apply for the rung they want rather than the rung they can be taken on.

It costs them a year, and it is entirely avoidable, and I would rather you were disappointed today than in March.

Role	What it pays, and where it sits
Guest relations, villa and chalet host	Fifty-five to a hundred and twenty thousand and upwards. The honest first rung if you are new to private service. It is not a lesser role: it is the one that teaches you the codes in a real house, and it climbs fast.
Private concierge, lifestyle manager	Seventy to a hundred and fifty thousand and upwards. Reachable directly from luxury hospitality, aviation, or private assistance. The purest expression of the craft in this programme.
Private or executive PA to a UHNW principal	Up to around two hundred and fifty thousand at the top of the market. A strong first private role if you come from a serious assistant background.
Estate or house manager	Median around a hundred and eighty-five thousand, with the top quartile above two hundred and sixty thousand. A senior step, after several years inside a household. Not an entry point, and anyone who tells you otherwise is selling you something.
Chief of staff	A hundred and fifty to three hundred and fifty thousand and upwards. The summit of a private-service career. Built on years of trust, not on eight weeks of study. We show you the path honestly, and the path is long.

Role	What it pays, and where it sits
Yacht and private aviation interior	Fifty to a hundred and thirty thousand and upwards. An excellent door, and it travels, and the season structure is unlike anything on land.

THE RULE

Choose the rung you can reach, and be impeccable on it.

The person who is impeccable in a chalet for one season is offered a household. The person who spends that season applying for estate manager roles she will not be given is, at the end of it, exactly where she started, and a year older, and considerably more discouraged.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

The market has four layers, and only the smallest one is visible to you.

It has seasons. January and September are the windows. Know them and use them.

It has a ladder. Choose the rung you can reach and be flawless on it.

CHAPTER IV

The agencies

How they actually work, and how to be in the folder

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand the agency's incentives, which are not yours.

Register in a way that puts you in the folder rather than in the pile.

4.1 · What an agency is, commercially

An agency is paid by the family, usually a percentage of the first year's salary, and only when a placement is made. Understand what that means about their behaviour, because it explains everything that will otherwise frustrate you.

- **They do not work for you.** They are pleasant to you, and they are not your advocate. Their client is the family, and their loyalty follows their invoice, and this is entirely proper and you should never resent it.
- **Their reputation is their only asset.** Which means they will not put forward anyone they are not confident about. One bad placement with a good family costs them the family for a decade.
- **They are not looking when you write to them.** They are filing. The role you are eventually presented for probably did not exist when you first made contact, and that is precisely why early contact matters.
- **They will ghost you, routinely, and it is not personal.** A consultant is holding forty candidates and eleven roles. Silence is not a judgement. It is arithmetic.

4.2 · The serious agencies, and how to tell

The market contains excellent firms and a number of unserious ones. The specialist houses that recur across London, Paris, Monaco, New York and Dubai include Morgan and Mallet International, Silver Swan Recruitment, Private Staff Group, Rose's Agency, Harper Associates, Luxury Assets, Exclusive Household Staff, and Achieve Hospitality. That is not an endorsement and it is not a list of contacts: it is a starting point for your own research, and doing that research is part of this week.

A serious agency will: interview you properly, take up your references before presenting you, tell you the truth about your rung, and **never ask you for money**. Hold that last one. It reappears in Chapter IX.

4.3 · How to register so that you are remembered

Most people

What you will do

Send a CV to a general inbox with the subject line "Application".

Write to a named consultant, having found out what that consultant actually recruits for, and say so in the first line.

Say what they want.

Say what you are, precisely, and what rung you are on, and be the rare candidate who is realistic. Consultants remember realism because they see almost none of it.

Apply to a specific role.

Ask to be registered, and say that you are not expecting anything immediately, and mean it. This single sentence changes how the conversation feels.

Follow up anxiously, or never.

Follow up once, at ninety days, with something real: a course completed, a season worked, a language reached. Not "just checking in", which is a message that asks them for something and gives them nothing.

CHAPTER V

The direct channel

The family office, and the introduction that is not cold

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand what a family office is and how it hires.

Approach the direct channel without being an intrusion.

DEFINITION

The family office. The private organisation that manages the wealth, investments, legal affairs, philanthropy, property and often the personal staffing of a single very wealthy family. A single-family office serves one family; a multi-family office serves several.

This is the entity that will very often employ you, pay you, and hold your contract. The principal is not your employer in any administrative sense. The family office is, and the people in it are the people whose opinion of you decides your renewal.

5.1 · How they hire

Quietly, through people they already trust, and with an overwhelming preference for someone who has been vouched for. A family office receiving an unsolicited approach from a stranger is receiving, from their point of view, a small security question. Understand that, and approach accordingly, and never take the silence personally.

5.2 · Where you are actually visible to them

- **Through the agencies they use.** Which is why Chapter IV comes first.
- **Through the staff they already employ.** The single most powerful channel in this profession, and the one you build in Chapter VI.
- **Through the suppliers who serve them.** The florist, the private chef, the charter broker, the villa manager. These people know who is hiring, months before anybody else, and almost nobody in your position thinks to be useful to them.
- **Through a season worked impeccably.** A chalet, a villa, a yacht. Every one of those houses is full of guests who have households of their own.

CHAPTER VI

Building a network from nothing

In ninety days, starting with nobody

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Build a real professional network from zero.

Understand why giving comes before asking, always.

6.1 · The principle

THE ONLY RULE OF NETWORKING IN THIS PROFESSION

You give first, you give without expectation, and you ask for nothing for a long time.

This is not a moral position. It is the only thing that works, because everybody in this world can recognise a person who wants something within ninety seconds, and they have all been approached a hundred times.

6.2 · The ninety-day plan

Phase	What you actually do
Days 1 to 30 · Map	You do not contact anybody. You build the map: sixty names, real people, in four categories. Agencies and named consultants. People currently doing the job you want. Suppliers who serve this world. Adjacent professionals: private chefs, chalet managers, charter brokers, villa agents.
Days 31 to 60 · Appear	You become visible in the places these people already are. Professional associations. Industry events. Serious online groups, where you contribute and do not sell. You answer questions, you never ask for anything, and you let people see that you are competent and quiet.
Days 61 to 90 · Reach	Now you write. Fifteen letters, each one individual, each one giving something and asking for almost nothing. Chapter VII is the method, and it is precise, and it works.
Day 91 onwards · Hold	A network that is not maintained is a list. Two contacts a week, forever. A useful article. A congratulation that is real. A supplier recommendation that costs you nothing and helps them.

6.3 · The people to actually cultivate

New entrants chase principals, and principals are unreachable and would not know what to do with them anyway. **The people who will actually change your career are two rungs above you, not twenty.**

A house manager in Geneva. A chalet manager in Verbier. A private chef who works for three families. A charter broker. These people hear about roles first, they are asked "do you know anyone", they are pleased to be useful, and they are entirely reachable. Nobody ever writes to them. Write to them.

CHAPTER VII

Cold outreach that becomes a warm introduction

The method, precisely

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Write an approach that is answered.

Understand why every element of the standard approach fails.

7.1 · Why the normal message fails

The normal message is about the sender. It says who they are, what they want, and what they are looking for, and it asks the recipient for time, advice, or a role. It is entirely reasonable, and it goes unanswered, and the sender concludes that this world is closed.

It is not closed. It is simply full of people asking for things.

7.2 · The structure that works

Element	What it does
The specific first line	You demonstrate, in one sentence, that you know exactly who they are and that this message could not have been sent to anyone else. Not flattery. A fact. Generic openings are deleted before the second line.
The honest position	One sentence, entirely without inflation, on what you are and where you are. Nobody at this level is fooled by inflation, and everybody is disarmed by accuracy.
The gift	Something useful to them, for nothing. A supplier they would want to know about. A candidate for a role you saw that you cannot fill yourself. A piece of information from your own world that is genuinely of use in theirs. If you cannot find a gift, you are not ready to send the message.
The small ask, or none at all	Not a job. Not an introduction. Not a coffee, which is an hour of their life. At most: one specific question that takes them ninety seconds to answer and that flatters their expertise rather than their ego.

Element	What it does
The exit	You make it effortless not to reply. "If it is not a good moment, please ignore this entirely." It sounds like a small politeness. It is the line that most often produces the reply.

7.3 · Then you wait, and you do the hard part

You do not follow up in a week. You wait. And if they answered, however briefly, you write again in three months **with something else that is useful to them and no ask at all.**

And the third time, six months later, you may ask, and you will get an answer, because by then you are not a stranger asking for something. You are a person they know, who has never once cost them anything. **That is what a warm introduction actually is, and it takes nine months, and there is no faster version of it that works.**

CHAPTER VIII

Your reputation

How this world actually checks you

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand that the reference is the whole market.

Build a reputation that speaks for you before you enter a room.

8.1 · How a hire really happens

A family will interview you. They will check your references, and they will do it properly. And then they will do the thing that decides it, and you will never see it happen.

They will ask someone they trust about you. Not a referee you named. Someone they already know, who might know you. And that conversation, which lasts about ninety seconds, is worth more than every document you have ever produced.

8.2 · What this means about how you behave, everywhere, always

- **You never leave a house badly.** Not the house that treated you unfairly. Not the house you were right about. This world is very small, and the person you were entitled to be angry with will be asked about you, and they will remember.
- **You never speak badly of a former employer.** Ever, anywhere, to anyone, including in an interview where you are invited to and it would be entirely justified. The person listening is not learning about them. They are learning what you will say about them.
- **You are decent to people who cannot help you.** The junior housekeeper. The driver. The agency assistant who is twenty-three. They talk to each other, they will all be senior in ten years, and this world is smaller than you can currently imagine.
- **You do what you said you would do.** The single most reliable reputation in this market belongs to the person whose word is boringly, unremarkably good.

CHAPTER IX

The traps of this market

Read this chapter twice

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Recognise every common exploitation of new entrants.

Know what a legitimate process looks like, so that the illegitimate one is obvious.

This profession attracts a certain number of people who make their living from the hopes of newcomers. You will meet them. They are pleasant and they are convincing and they will find you within weeks of your first application.

The trap	How to recognise it, and what to do
The agency that charges you	A legitimate agency is paid by the family. It never charges the candidate a registration fee, a placement fee, a "priority listing" or a mandatory training. If you are asked for money to be represented, you walk away, and you tell other people.
The unpaid trial that never ends	A paid trial day is normal and reasonable. Two unpaid weeks "to see how you fit" is not a trial. It is free labour, and it does not end in a role.
The training that promises placement	Anyone guaranteeing you a job at the end of a course is either lying or has not read the law in their country. A school teaches. A school cannot hire you. This one applies to us too, and I want you to hear it from me: Maison Amarine does not place you, and would be lying to you if it said otherwise.
The role with no name	A family that will not tell an agency who they are, or a "principal" who approaches you directly with no verifiable identity. Discretion is normal at this level. Total anonymity, before any contract, is not discretion. It is a warning.
The contract that does not exist	Cash, no contract, no papers, "we prefer to keep it simple". It is simple until the day you are dismissed, or injured, or accused of something, and then you have nothing at all, and you are alone in a foreign country.
The role that is not a role	Especially in certain markets, and I will say this plainly because nobody else will: if the interview process is asking about your appearance more than your competence, if the role is vague, if the salary makes no sense for the work described, leave. Immediately, without politeness, and without answering the next message.

THE RULE THAT COVERS ALL SIX

If you cannot verify who is hiring you, what you will be doing, what you will be paid, and what your contract says, you are not being offered a role.

And no opportunity, at any salary, is worth what those six situations cost the people who accepted them.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

A real agency is paid by the family, never by you. There is no exception to this.

No school can promise you a placement. Including this one, and I would rather you heard it from me.

If you cannot verify the family, the role, the salary and the contract, there is no role.

Glossary

The hidden market · The referral and invisible layers, where most good roles are actually filled, and which you cannot see.

The folder · The agency's existing list of known candidates. Being in it before a role exists is the whole game.

Family office · The private organisation managing a family's wealth, property and staffing. Very often your legal employer.

Single-family office · Serves one family. Multi-family office: serves several.

The rung · The role you can realistically be taken on today, as opposed to the one you want.

The season · The market's hiring rhythm. January and September are the two windows.

The gift · The useful thing you give a stranger before you ever ask them for anything. The core of all outreach that works.

The warm introduction · What cold outreach becomes after nine months of giving and not asking.

The back channel · The unnamed person a family asks about you. It decides the hire, and you will never see it.

Self-assessment

Answer in writing, before the practice.

1. Name the four layers of this market and explain why the one you can see is the worst one to fight in.
2. It is the fifteenth of June. You want a role. What does the season tell you about what you should be doing this month, and what you should not?
3. Place yourself honestly on the ladder. Name the rung, and name the evidence for it. Then name the rung you were tempted to write instead.
4. Explain, in one paragraph, why an agency is pleasant to you and is not on your side, and why you should never resent this.
5. What are the four things a serious agency does, and the one thing it never does?
6. What is a family office, and why does the person who signs your contract matter to how you behave?
7. Name the four people you should be cultivating who are two rungs above you, not twenty. Give real names if you can.
8. Write a cold outreach message of under a hundred and twenty words, containing a specific first line, an honest position, a real gift, and an exit. Then delete the ask.
9. Why is a warm introduction a nine-month process, and what is the faster version, and why does the faster version not work?
10. You are asked for four hundred euros to be added to an agency's priority list. Write your reply, and then write what you do next.

Further study

- **Research five agencies properly this week.** Not their homepage. Who their consultants are, what they specialise in, which markets they actually serve, and what they say they require. Then write down which one is genuinely for you, and which three are not.
 - **Find ten people currently doing the job you want,** and read everything public they have written. You are not contacting them yet. You are learning what the job sounds like from inside.
 - **Learn the vocabulary of the family office:** single family office, multi-family office, principal, chief of staff, private trustee. You will be in a conversation where these words are used within your first month.
 - **Ask yourself, honestly, whether you would hire you.** Write the answer down. This is the exercise that produces the market entry plan.
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